

9.4 Organisation of the visit

The visit may take a variety of forms, provided it gives students an opportunity to meet the assessment criteria given above; there are no restrictions on the nature of the visit. Some teachers may wish to arrange a whole-class visit to an industrial or research institution. Some students may prefer to make their own arrangements to visit a local venue, such as a hospital, garden centre or supermarket. However the visit is arranged, teachers should ensure that students are aware of the criteria by which their work will be assessed and ensure that these criteria may be met under the particular circumstance of the proposed visit(s).

Teachers will generally need to contact the chosen venue well in advance of the visit. In some cases an initial approach by the teacher will be followed up by students making their own contact. Whatever the nature of the visit, it is essential to ensure that students will be able to observe biology at a level appropriate for AS students and that due regard is paid to health and safety. Students are expected to explore the biology they observe during their visit and this exploration should contribute to their report. The report must show evidence obtained from a range of sources and be presented to a named target audience. A student who has asked biology-related questions during the visit, kept a record of biology observed and discussed, and read any literature supplied by the venue, should be able to meet the relevant assessment criteria.